During the Proteas' 1999 tour to New Zealand, I managed to befriend a certain young lady in Auckland during the second Test. Some of the guys and I were out for a bite to eat at a local restaurant and, as pretty girls often do, she caught my eye. I thought she was gorgeous – dark-haired, very good frame, though she did have a bit of a big nose. Mark Boucher called her *hakneus* … but I reckon he was just jealous that I had made a move before he could.

For some reason, women loved our South African accents, no matter where we travelled. Whether it was in Australia, New Zealand, the UK or the West Indies, women took a liking to our accents, which certainly opened a few doors for us. That particular tour to New Zealand was no different. And I could tell this girl was keen right from the get-go. And so was I.

In those days I used to drink copious amounts of the energy drink Red Bull. Their South African sports manager, Tristan Werner, used to send me cases wherever I was in the world. Still does, actually. I've a huge amount of natural enthusiasm for life as it is – the Red Bull amped that up, so I was revved up and ready to fly.

I didn't take the girl home that same night, but managed to get her contact details and made arrangements to take her out the next evening. I decided to make plans for a special evening. You know … spoil her a bit.

I told her we were going to have a French-themed evening with a difference … French champagne and French fries, and the last French item would be a surprise. She smiled. I think she guessed where the evening was heading, but she was practically speaking in a French accent by then, so I knew my French-flavoured hattrick was still on the cards.

It was a pretty romantic evening – I may have been horny as hell, but I'm also a big romantic at heart and enjoy all that mushy, soft stuff too. Part of the old charm, I guess. So ja, I did seal the deal that night, and for a few nights after that too. When I later told the guys of my exploits, the 'French Evening' – French champagne, French fries and, yes, a French letter – became a bit of a legend. They all found it very amusing.

It was a fun time for both of us – I really liked her and we hung out quite a lot on that tour. We kept in touch for a while afterwards too. The last time I saw her was about six or seven years ago in London. It was typical of 'what happens on tour stays on tour'.

The only problem is that – and no doubt I'll get flak from the Kiwis for saying this (it's clearly a touchy subject) – there just aren't too many